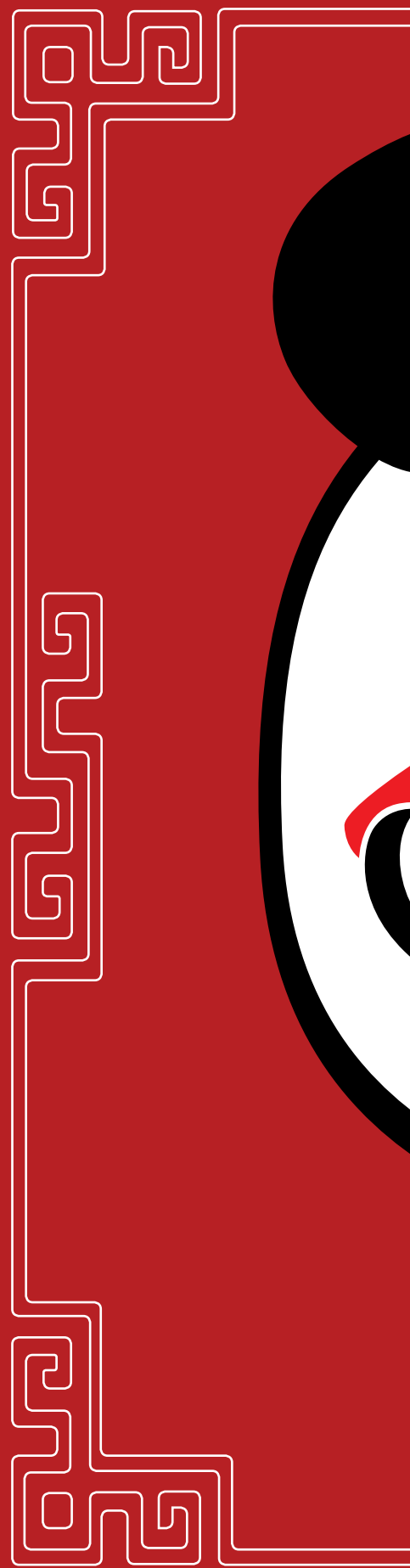
THE CHINA SNOOPING MENACE

CHINESE-MADE CCTVs ACROSS INDIA COULD WELL BE ACTING AS THE EYES AND EARS OF BEIJING. EXPERTS RAISE CONCERNS OF NATIONAL SECURITY, BUT EXISTING LAWS AND AWARENESS ARE INADEQUATE TO DEAL WITH THE THREAT

By **PRADIP R. SAGAR**

Illustrations by **NILANJAN DAS**



WHILE INDIAN AND CHINESE GENERALS WERE engaged in serious talks to end the worst military stand-off in 50 years between the two countries at the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Ladakh in 2020-21, Beijing was suspected to have been playing a double game with New Delhi. In August 2021, almost 15 months after the bloody clash between troops that resulted in scores of deaths, cyber groups linked with the Chinese government were reported to have been engaged in a massive cyber-espionage operation. The intent was to target seven major electricity load dispatch centres (ELDCs) near the LAC in Ladakh to disrupt power supply to the region at